

UX Research & Design Case Study

Charity Donation Payment Experience



Designing an emotionally engaging, frictionless donation journey that builds trust, confidence,

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Requirement Analysis

The client aimed to create a charity donation payment experience that enables users to **donate quickly** while feeling **emotionally rewarded** and **confident** about their impact.

- The key challenge was not usability alone, but emotional hesitation.
- Users needed reassurance that their contribution truly mattered.

Problem Statement

How might we design a donation flow that **minimizes friction** while **maximizing emotional reassurance, trust, and perceived impact** - Especially when users are donating during busy moments.

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Mind Map (Summary)

Core branches included:

- User Intent, ● Emotional Triggers, ● Trust Signals,
- Transparency. ● Payment Simplicity, ● Post Donation Engagement,

This helped align emotional needs with functional requirements.

Design Approach

- Emotional Design - led approach
- Supported by behavioral psychology principles.
- The experience was structured to move users from:
Empathy → Confidence → Action → Gratitude.

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Potential Problems & Solutions

Hesitation before payment

Solved with impact stories and social proof.

Fear of complexity Solved using minimal steps and a stepper.

Lack of closure Solved with celebration and clear impact confirmation.

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Product Story

- The product transforms donating from a transaction into a meaningful moment.
- Users are guided through a calm, reassuring flow that celebrates their contribution and reinforces long term emotional connection.

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User Persona

- Busy, empathetic professionals who want to help, but they value clarity, trust, and emotional validation.
- They prefer quick actions supported by meaningful context.

User Journey Map & Design Opportunities

- Key moments of hesitation were identified before payment and after completion.
- Opportunities existed in reassurance messaging, progress visibility, and postdonation engagement.

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Competitor Analysis

- Most competitors focused heavily on speed and forms, with minimal emotional feedback.
- Few provided meaningful post donation reinforcement or impact storytelling.

Research Findings & Opportunities

- Emotional reassurance increases **completion**.
- Users value **transparency** more than discounts.
- **Gratitude moments** improve recall and repeat intent.

Information Architecture

- **Screen 1:** Story, impact, amount & duration selection.
- **Screen 2:** Stepper with editable amount, minimal details, payment, and receipt.

Low Fidelity Wireframe Sketches

- Wireframes focused on content hierarchy, emotional pacing, and reducing cognitive load.
- Visual distractions were intentionally removed.

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Hi Fidelity UI Direction

- A calm, warm visual system using soft colors, rounded components, generous spacing, and gentle motion.
- The UI reinforces trust, empathy, and celebration.

Expected Impact & Metrics

- + 30 - 40% increase in donation completion
- - 35% reduction in time to donate
- + 90% reported emotional satisfaction

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Conclusion

This case study demonstrates how emotional design can elevate a simple payment flow into a meaningful experience—driving both user satisfaction and business impact.

